

词汇: *animals* 动物

- 1 Animals build their homes to achieve different living goals. Bees build **hives** to store and protect food, spiders **spin** webs to catch **prey** and beavers build **dams** to create pools. But, as you walk around a town or stroll along a countryside pathway, you may notice some **unique** homes up on the treetops – **nests**.
- 2 Like **architects**, birds carefully **engineer** their nests before building them. A report named *Architectural traditions in the structures built by cooperative weaver birds* says that their designs are influenced by those before them. A study released by iScience finds that birds follow a culture that gets **passed down**. Not the high culture of art, literature and music, but an older process of **transmitting traits** and skills through **generations**.
- 3 *Bird nest building: visions for the future*, says that birds who are first-time builders will often copy familiar individuals, highlighting how important this individual, perhaps the parent, is. Sound familiar? An article in the National Library of Medicine explains how children learn by **imitating** their **caregiver**.
- 4 These behaviours, though, can also change in response to pressures of natural **selection**, a term **coined** by Charles Darwin in his theory of **evolution**. Competition is one of the three components of that theory.
- 5 And it's not just in the human world where certain property locations are highly **desirable**. Some species of birds even steal nest locations from others. Studies at the Zoological Society of London have discovered that **invasive** species will compete with **native** birds for suitable trees to build their nests in. Experiments published in Science Direct also show that most female birds look for fresh, green nests when choosing their **mate**. A report from RSPB further adds that in some species of birds, such as wrens, the male will build multiple nests from which the female can choose her favourite and even tidy it up. This tells us that, like humans, the quality of a home, in addition to its location and cleanliness, can influence whether a pair of birds decide to live and start a family there.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

Paragraph 5 _____

- a. Bird behaviours can change
- b. Bird behaviours never change
- c. Birds and other animals' homes
- d. Birds compete for the best home
- e. Birds copy behaviours
- f. Birds have culture

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. You'll often find birds' nests on the grounds in the countryside.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. Birds are influenced by ...
 - a. beavers.
 - b. bees.
 - c. other birds.
3. Research published in the National Library of Medicine explains that children's ability to learn...
 - a. can come from copying.
 - b. can only improve by going to school.
 - c. comes from their genetics.
4. Charles Darwin created the theory of evolution by...
 - a. natural competition.
 - b. natural protection.
 - c. natural selection.

5. Research from the Zoological Society of London shows us that birds will compete for the nest location to build their homes.
- a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

The **1)** _____ of nests is often **2)** _____ as part of bird culture. They often learn by **3)** _____ other birds around them and will try to build the best nest with hopes of finding a **4)** _____. Scientists think that these behaviours are part of birds' **5)** _____.

architecture	evolution	imitating
generations		mate
passed down		transmitting

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

hive	蜂巢
spin	编织，纺织
prey	猎物
dam	水坝
unique	独特的
nest	鸟巢
architect	建筑师
engineer	设计，筑造
pass down	传承，在世代间传递
transmit	传递，传播
trait	特征
generation	世代，一代
imitate	模仿
caregiver	看护者
selection	挑选，选择
coin	创造，首次使用（某一词语）
evolution	进化
desirable	理想的，渴望获得的
invasive	入侵性的，外来的
native	当地的，土生土长的
mate	配偶

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **c) Birds and other animals' homes**

Paragraph 2 **f) Birds have culture**

Paragraph 3 **e) Birds copy behaviours**

Paragraph 4 **a) Bird behaviours can change**

Paragraph 5 **d) Birds compete for the best home**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b. False.** *But, as you walk around a town or walk along a countryside pathway, you may notice some unique homes **up on the treetops** – nests.*
2. **c.** *Like humans and architecture, **birds carefully engineer their nests** before building them, and **their designs would've been influenced by those before them.***
3. **a.** ... *An article published in the National Library of Medicine explains how **children learn by imitating their caregiver.***
4. **c.** *These behaviours, though, can also change in response to pressures of selection – or **natural selection**. Coined by Charles Darwin, competition is one of the three components of the Darwinian theory of evolution.*
5. **a. True.** *Studies at the Zoological Society of London have discovered **that invasive species of birds will compete with native birds for suitable trees.***

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

The **architecture** of nests is often **passed down** as part of bird culture. They often learn by **imitating** other birds around them and will try to build the best nest with hopes of finding a **mate**. Scientists think that these behaviours are part of birds' **evolution**.